

Dusty Romantic — Signature

For Aliyah Gluckstadt, 130 East Hamilton Ave, Englewood. Ordered by her mother, Aviva. Sourced at retail — a wholesale box minimum makes no sense for one arrangement.

PALETTE

Mauve, antique rose, muted plum, dusty blush

Your own words for this collection. Swatches below are indicative, not measured — buy to the words, not to the squares.



Mauve



Antique rose



Muted plum



Dusty blush

BEFORE YOU BUY ANYTHING

It isn't a vase

The product photo is a **low, wide footed bowl** — roughly 8–9 inches across, 4–5 tall, stone or matte ceramic. A compote, not a vase. If you set this in a tall vase it becomes a different piece and the silhouette collapses.

Which means mechanics: a **chicken-wire ball** taped in with waterproof tape, or a pin frog. No foam.

And if the bowl is unglazed stone or concrete, it is **porous** — it will weep, sweat and leave a ring on her table. So it needs a **liner**, not a film: a plain plastic or glass bowl dropped inside, sitting just below the rim, with the wire and the water in *that*. Cellophane alone shifts in transit and shows.

Simplest of all: use a **glazed or glass vessel** and the problem never arises. The silhouette is what carries this piece — low, wide, footed — not the material.

Grouped by stop, not by flower

About 28–36 stems for Signature scale. Tick as you go.

FARMSTAND OR FARMERS MARKET

Late September is peak dahlia. This is where the moody end of the palette lives — nothing at a supermarket will match it.

- ☐ Dahlias — plum, burgundy, café 4–5

Standing in for hellebore, which is a late-winter flower and won't be found this week.

- ☐ Smoke bush, or any plum-toned foliage 2–3

Carries the depth the hellebore leaves behind. Garden clippings count.

TRADER JOE'S

Reliable for the soft mass. Pick by colour and walk past anything clear or bright — one true pink breaks the whole palette.

- ☐ Roses — dusty blush through terracotta 5–6

Mixed head sizes if you can. Avoid clear pink and anything red.

- ☐ Lisianthus — lavender / mauve 4–5

If none: mauve spray roses do the same job.

- ☐ Eucalyptus — willow or parvifolia 2–3

For the long trailing line down one side. Needs real length.

WHOLE FOODS, OR A RETAIL FLORIST

The gap-filler stop. Skip it entirely if the first two came through.

☐ Scabiosa — burgundy 3–4

These ride above the mass on thin stems; that lift is what makes it read as yours. If unavailable: scabiosa pods, astrantia, or small dahlias left long.

☐ Plume texture — astilbe if it exists 6–8

Very tail of astilbe season. Dried grasses (already in your Fall Edit) or dusty limonium do the job and suit the month better.

CHECK AT HOME FIRST

Find the shortfall today, while there's still time to fix it.

☐ Low footed bowl, 8–9" 1

☐ Chicken wire + waterproof tape —

☐ Flower food, clean bucket, sharp snips —

☐ A6 or 4x6 envelope — cream or white 1

Staples, same trip as the tag pickup.

BUILD

Thursday evening

I **Condition first**

Cut
on
an
angle,
strip
everything
below
the
waterline,
two
hours
minimum
in
cool
water
somewhere
dark.
Non-
negotiable
if
it's
travelling
Friday.

2 Wire the bowl

Chicken-
wire
ball,
waterproof
tape
across
in a
cross,
water
just
under
the
rim.

3 Greenery sets the shape

Low
and
wide.
Establish
the
one
long
trailing
line
down
a
single
side
—
the
asymmetry
is
the
whole
silhouette.

4 **Roses next**

Asymmetric
cluster,
varied
heights,
faces
turned
differently.
Never
a
dome.

5 **Dahlias recessed**

Set
slightly
deeper
than
the
roses.
That's
where
the
depth
comes
from.

6 **Lisianthus to bridge**

Between
the
mass
and
the
air.

7 Scabiosa last, riding high

Above
the
mass
on
their
own
stems.
Resist
tucking
them
in.

8 Texture into the gaps

Fill
the
negative
space
without
closing
it.
Stop
earlier
than
feels
finished.

TIMING

Thursday build, Friday drive

WED	Shop. Condition everything the moment you're home.
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THU	Build. Print the card once Aviva confirms the wording. Text Aliyah to lock a morning window.
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THU NIGHT	Somewhere cool and dark, out of any draught.
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FRI AM	Load flat and wedged. Twenty minutes to Englewood. Hand over, then text Aviva that it arrived — she's abroad and can't see it.
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Your own site says no two arrangements are identical. You are not matching a photograph stem for stem — you're delivering that palette at Signature scale. Aviva bought mauve, antique rose, muted plum and dusty blush. Give her those and she has exactly what she paid for.